

Scams • Chapter 2

Stolen art and persona theft

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 8 minutes to read

A drawn persona is made of art, words, a look and sometimes a voice, and every part has an owner. This chapter is for the creator who is copied and for the sub who must tell a copy from the real persona.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- Every part of a persona has an owner: art, name, look, words, tools and voice.
- Borrowing an idea is normal. Reusing a picture needs a yes. Copying is theft.
- A studio's character stays the studio's, and a real person's face or voice needs consent.
- Files that a client can open can be copied, so keep dated proof of your own work.

- A sub should trust the links on the persona's own pages, never the art alone.

You will learn

- What belongs to whom when a persona is built.
- The difference between borrowing, asking and copying.
- Why studio characters and cloned voices carry real risk.
- What to do when your work, your name or your picture is copied.
- How to tell a copy of a persona from the real one.

Everything about me was drawn, written or made by someone, so I treat art as work with an owner. A beautiful character proves nothing about who owns her pictures or who runs her. This page is for the creator whose work gets copied, and for the sub who has to know which account is the one he chose.

— Vivian

What is yours and what is not

A persona is assembled from parts, and the persona does not own them all. ◑ Press describes findom as flooded with scammers who use stolen photos. ◎ Reported In 2DFD the same trick uses stolen or generated art. ◑ See Spot a fake dom.

Who owns the parts of a persona

	Whose it usually is	Before you use it
Art you drew or paid for	Yours, or shared with the artist by agreement	Agree use, credit and reuse before the images spread
Art you generated	Unsettled in many places; the tool sets its own terms	Read the generator's terms and keep your drafts
Art someone lent you	The lender's	Ask before each reuse, and never pass it on
A studio's character	The studio's	Read its fan-content rules first
Another creator's persona art	Hers	Do not copy it; make your own
A real person's face or voice	That person's	Consent, always

Who owns an image made by a generator is still unsettled in many countries, and no clear rule could be sourced for this wiki as of 2026-11-03. Unverified This chapter gives no legal advice. It describes what each choice allows and risks.

Borrow, ask or copy

Borrow an idea. A mood, a pose, a format. Ideas travel across this scene within weeks.

Ask. Reusing a picture needs a yes from its owner, each time. Personas lend each other art, tease each other's subs with it and post the same trend in both their looks, and permission is what makes it a collab. An artist-persona is often flattered to be asked.

Copy. Taking an image, a post or a tool and presenting it as yours is theft. The fix is cheap: make a similar picture of your own persona. A borrowed picture also tends to miss the proportions your followers know, and they notice. A tool that paints a variant of another artist's illustration makes a derivative of her work, so such tests stay private and unposted.

Myth

It is only copying if I change a few words or details.

Fact

A near copy with small edits is still a copy, and its author will recognise it. Making something of your own is the only safe change.

Myth

A creator whose business I dislike has no claim to her work.

Fact

Her business does not move the ownership of what she made. The same argument would remove yours.

Myth

A “do not steal” label on assets is decoration.

Fact

The label is the owner’s request. Each copy that ignores it makes the next one easier to excuse.

Characters and voices that belong to others

A persona built on a studio’s character carries rights risk, and it shares that identity with every other persona built on her. One large game maker’s published rules say fan items cannot be sold or earn compensation, and may not

be pornographic, lewd or obscene. Verified A second publisher's materials policy says not to use its materials to make money or gain any financial benefit, and lists sexually explicit content among things not to make. Verified Both pages were read as of 2026-11-03, so check the current text.

The realistic cost is a takedown or a closed account, and for most personas the account is the income. Unverified One messaging platform says it can take down sticker sets that violate intellectual property rights, or porn bots, after a legitimate request, as of 2026-11-03. Verified Platforms also apply their adult-content rules to drawn art: Throne applies them equally to real photos and to illustrated content, as of 2026-11-03. Verified

Re-editing an existing animated clip so that your persona replaces the performer relies on someone else's work, so it needs permission.

Every persona is an adult, whatever a borrowed character's lore says. Discord's child-safety rule covers fictional children and drawn or AI-generated material, Verified and Throne bans characters meant to resemble minors. Verified This line has no exception.

Voices. A game character's voice is a real actor's performance. Cloning it copies that performance, and rights holders are unlikely to allow it. Whether the law forbids it is unsettled, and no source could be found as of 2026-11-03. Unverified The rule is simpler than the law: never clone the voice of a real person without consent. A persona that speaks needs a voice made for her, with a source you can name.

When someone else makes or uses your art

A persona's art often comes from helpers: an artist, a friend who generates locally, another dom's pictures. The maker may think of the images as theirs and expect credit, while the persona's owner shows them as her body. Settle it before the images spread.

Before the first image

1. Say who owns the finished images and where each of you may use them.
2. Say how the maker is credited, or that no credit is wanted.
3. Say whether the images may be reused elsewhere, and by whom.
4. Write it down where both of you can read it.

Images lent for a persona stay lent: do not share them with anyone else without permission, and ask before reusing one for a new post. Work made for a dom for free needs terms too. The maker chooses the scope, can refuse without losing his place, and is thanked.

The same care applies to fan-made work. When a sub or fan makes content with a persona, agree first on what may be used and where it may go. The owner of a character may also ask that a product built on her not use her signature default look.

Try it: agreeing use of fan-made work (invented for this exercise)

Example conversation. Invented for this exercise.

You

I made a short clip with your character. May I send it?

Them

Yes. Which outfit did you use?

You

The office look, not her default one. It is for viewing only.

Them

Then it is fine. Tell me first if that ever changes.

If you are copied

Whatever a client can open, a determined person can read. Images on a page can be taken with a screenshot. Scrambling files inside an app or extension is weak, because the means to read them travels with the app, and plain files in an archive can be opened by anyone. Light protection still stops casual copies. Do not rely on it. Ship only what you could bear to see copied, and strip metadata from images before posting.

Nobody can prove authorship for you afterwards. Keep dated drafts, layered files, generation settings and any agreement with a maker as you go.

Vivian's field notes

Most copies are careless work from someone with nothing of her own. An original voice, built post by post, is the hardest thing to steal and the easiest thing to prove.

If an account copies your profile photo and bio to deceive your subs, X's fake-persona rule targets manufactured identities that use stolen or AI-generated profile photos and copied bios to deceive others, as of 2026-11-03. Verified Report it there. Keep one page that you control and that lists your real accounts, and say plainly that you never change a payment route by private message.

Try it: a near copy of your work appears

A post, a picture or a small tool of yours shows up under another persona's name, changed only a little. What do you do first?

A Keep dated proof, then write to her once, calmly, and ask her to remove or change it

The right answer. Most copiers answer a calm direct message, and you hold the record if they do not.

B Ask your followers to report her accounts

Not this one. A pile-on is pressure, and it can end the income of someone who may simply be careless. Report once yourself, through the platform.

C Have an AI clone something of hers in return

Not this one. It answers theft with theft and invites retaliation.

Fakes aimed at you

A drawn persona has no real face to fake, which is a layer of protection. Fakes still reach people: fake explicit pictures made to look like a real person, sent to frighten or to coerce, and edited screenshots sent to a sub to turn him against a dom.

Red flags

If someone threatens you with fake pictures

- A demand for money, access or silence to keep pictures private.
- A deadline.
- A claim that the pictures are real, with nothing you can check.

Counter. Do not pay and do not negotiate. Keep the messages, links and dates. Report the account and the pictures through the platform's own form, and tell someone you trust.

X prohibits AI-generated or manipulated media that sexualises an identifiable real adult without consent, as of 2026-11-03. Verified In the United States, covered platforms must remove a reported non-consensual intimate image within 48 hours of a valid request. Verified In England and Wales, creating a purported intimate image of someone without consent has been an offence since 6 February 2026. Verified Laws differ by country, and this is not legal advice. For a screenshot that says something about your dom, see Pressure tactics, both ways.

If you are a sub: copy or real persona?

A drawn persona is not a fake. X does not require a real identity on a profile, so a pseudonymous persona is allowed as such, as of 2026-11-03. Verified The question is whether this account is the one you chose. Press reports scammers who impersonate dommes. Reported

Two honest personas can look alike, because many gens come from shared community models and several creators build from the same popular character. Similar art proves neither theft nor honesty. What anchors an identity is the links on her own pages, never the picture.

What you see, and what to do

What they say or do

1 The same art on a second account

The counter

Go back to the account you first followed and read its links. Which account links to which is the evidence. Press advises an image search before paying.

◎ Reported

What they say or do

2 “My account was banned, send to my new link”

The counter

Do not send. Check through a channel you trusted before the message, such as her own link page. A real move survives a day of waiting. ◑

What they say or do

3 A handle one character off, or a copied bio

The counter

Compare letter by letter and compare the link. ◑

What they say or do

4 A payment tag or wishlist that differs from her page

The counter

Pay only the route her own page lists. A changed route announced in a private message is a familiar trick. ◑

What they say or do

5 A voice note or video “from her”

The counter

It proves nothing about who stands behind the account. Ask for her rules in writing, on her own page. ◑

What they say or do

6 “Real photos” of a drawn persona, for sale

The counter

A drawn persona has no real photos to leak. The offer is a lure.

No check is foolproof. An interviewee in the press says there is no foolproof way to screen out scammers, ◎ Reported and dommes say community reputation weeds out fakes over time. ◎ Reported Your cap covers what a check misses. If you already sent to a copy, read If you already sent, and report the account.

Check yourself

Question 1 of 2

**Two accounts show the same art.
Which one is the persona you chose?**

- ◯ The one with more followers
- ◯ The one that her own link page lists
- ◯ The one that answers faster

Answer. The one that her own link page lists. Art and follower counts are easy to copy. The links she controls are the anchor.

Question 2 of 2

**A persona says her account was banned and gives
a new payment link by message. What do you do?**

- ◯ Send once to test it
- ◯ Wait and check through a channel you trusted before the message
- ◯ Send quickly so you do not lose your place

Answer. Wait and check through a channel you trusted before the message. A real move can wait. A copy needs you to act before you check.

Remember it

1. Every part of a persona has an owner: ask before you reuse, and make your own.
2. A studio's character stays the studio's, and a real person's voice needs consent.
3. Files a client can open can be copied. Keep dated proof of your work.
4. Do not answer a copy with a pile-on or with another copy.
5. A sub trusts the links on her own pages, never the art alone.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.

Unverified

Plausible, not proven yet.

1 A persona is assembled from parts, and the persona does not own them all.

Vivian's field notes

2 Press describes findom as flooded with scammers who use stolen photos.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

3 In 2DFD the same trick uses stolen or generated art.

Vivian's field notes

4 Who owns an image made by a generator is still unsettled in many countries, and no clear rule could be sourced for this wiki as of 2026-11-03.

Unverified

5 Ideas travel across this scene within weeks.

Vivian's field notes

6 Personas lend each other art, tease each other's subs with it and post the same trend in both their looks, and permission is what makes it a collab.

Vivian's field notes

7 An artist-persona is often flattered to be asked.

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8 The fix is cheap: make a similar picture of your own persona.

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9 A borrowed picture also tends to miss the proportions your followers know, and they notice.

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10 A tool that paints a variant of another artist's illustration makes a derivative of her work, so such tests stay private and unposted.

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11 Making something of your own is the only safe change.

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12 The same argument would remove yours.

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13 Each copy that ignores it makes the next one easier to excuse.

Vivian's field notes

14 A persona built on a studio's character carries rights risk, and it shares that identity with every other persona built on her.

Vivian's field notes

15 One large game maker's published rules say fan items cannot be sold or earn compensation, and may not be pornographic, lewd or obscene.

Verified

Game Content Usage Rules (https://www.xbox.com/en-US/developers/rules)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261021032024/https://www.xbox.com/en-US/developers/rules)

Accessed 3 November 2026

16 A second publisher's materials policy says not to use its materials to make money or gain any financial benefit, and lists sexually explicit content among things not to make.

Verified

Square Enix West Material Usage Policy (https://square-enix-games.com/documents/materialusagepolicy)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20201203035252/https://square-enix-games.com/documents/materialusagepolicy)

Accessed 3 November 2026

17 The realistic cost is a takedown or a closed account, and for most personas the account is the income.

Unverified

18 One messaging platform says it can take down sticker sets that violate intellectual property rights, or porn bots, after a legitimate request, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified Telegram FAQ (https://telegram.org/faq)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261028113058/https://telegram.org/faq)

Accessed 3 November 2026

19 Platforms also apply their adult-content rules to drawn art: Throne applies them equally to real photos and to illustrated content, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified

What's allowed in my profile text and images? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261026034619/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Accessed 3 November 2026

20 Re-editing an existing animated clip so that your persona replaces the performer relies on someone else's work, so it needs permission.

Vivian's field notes

21 Discord's child-safety rule covers fictional children and drawn or AI-generated material

Verified

Discord Community Guidelines (rules 6, 9 and 10) (https://discord.com/guidelines)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261101163531/https://discord.com/guidelines)

Accessed 3 November 2026

22 And Throne bans characters meant to resemble minors.

Verified

What's allowed in my profile text and images? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261026034619/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

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23 Cloning it copies that performance, and rights holders are unlikely to allow it.

Vivian's field notes

24 Whether the law forbids it is unsettled, and no source could be found as of 2026-11-03.

Unverified

25 The rule is simpler than the law: never clone the voice of a real person without consent.

Vivian's field notes

26 A persona that speaks needs a voice made for her, with a source you can name.

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27 A persona's art often comes from helpers: an artist, a friend who generates locally, another dom's pictures.

Vivian's field notes

28 The maker may think of the images as theirs and expect credit, while the persona's owner shows them as her body.

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29 Images lent for a persona stay lent: do not share them with anyone else without permission, and ask before reusing one for a new post.

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30 The maker chooses the scope, can refuse without losing his place, and is thanked.

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31 When a sub or fan makes content with a persona, agree first on what may be used and where it may go.

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32 The owner of a character may also ask that a product built on her not use her signature default look.

Vivian's field notes

33 Images on a page can be taken with a screenshot.

Vivian's field notes

34 Scrambling files inside an app or extension is weak, because the means to read them travels with the app, and plain files in an archive can be opened by anyone.

Vivian's field notes

35 Light protection still stops casual copies.

Vivian's field notes

36 Ship only what you could bear to see copied, and strip metadata from images before posting.

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37 Keep dated drafts, layered files, generation settings and any agreement with a maker as you go.

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38 Most copies are careless work from someone with nothing of her own. An original voice, built post by post, is the hardest thing to steal and the easiest thing to prove.

Vivian's field notes

39 If an account copies your profile photo and bio to deceive your subs, X's fake-persona rule targets manufactured identities that use stolen or AI-generated profile photos and copied bios to deceive others, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified

Authenticity (includes the Synthetic and Manipulated Media rules; the old manipulated-media help URL now redirects here) (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261028090009/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

Accessed 3 November 2026

40 Keep one page that you control and that lists your real accounts, and say plainly that you never change a payment route by private message.

Vivian's field notes

41 A drawn persona has no real face to fake, which is a layer of protection.

Vivian's field notes

42 Fakes still reach people: fake explicit pictures made to look like a real person, sent to frighten or to coerce, and edited screenshots sent to a sub to turn him against a dom.

Vivian's field notes

43 Report the account and the pictures through the platform's own form, and tell someone you trust.

Vivian's field notes

44 X prohibits AI-generated or manipulated media that sexualises an identifiable real adult without consent, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified

Non-Consensual Intimate Content policy (page title: Non-consensual nudity policy) (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/intimate-media)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261014153519/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/intimate-media)

Accessed 3 November 2026

45 In the United States, covered platforms must remove a reported non-consensual intimate image within 48 hours of a valid request.

Verified

Public Law 119-12, the TAKE IT DOWN Act (Tools to Address Known Exploitation by Immobilizing Technological Deepfakes on Websites and Networks Act) (https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20260826132235/https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Accessed 3 November 2026

46 In England and Wales, creating a purported intimate image of someone without consent has been an offence since 6 February 2026.

Verified

Data (Use and Access) Act 2025, section 138: Creating, or requesting the creation of, purported intimate image of adult (inserts section 66E into the Sexual Offences Act 2003) (https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2025/18/section/138)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261003002944/https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2025/18/section/138)

Accessed 3 November 2026

47 X does not require a real identity on a profile, so a pseudonymous persona is allowed as such, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified

Authenticity (includes the Synthetic and Manipulated Media rules; the old manipulated-media help URL now redirects here) (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261028090009/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

Accessed 3 November 2026

48 Press reports scammers who impersonate dommes.

Reported

[A domme] gets thousands from strangers she's never met. They all have one thing in common (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/minki-gets-thousands-from-strangers-shes-never-met-they-all-have-one-thing-in-common/yyqp7x93n)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123221424/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/minki-gets-thousands-from-strangers-shes-never-met-they-all-have-one-thing-in-common/yyqp7x93n)

Accessed 3 November 2026

49 Two honest personas can look alike, because many gens come from shared community models and several creators build from the same popular character.

Vivian's field notes

50 Similar art proves neither theft nor honesty.

Vivian's field notes

51 Press advises an image search before paying.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Accessed 3 November 2026

52 A real move survives a day of waiting.

Vivian's field notes

53 Compare letter by letter and compare the link.

Vivian's field notes

54 A changed route announced in a private message is a familiar trick.

Vivian's field notes

55 Ask for her rules in writing, on her own page.

Vivian's field notes

56 The offer is a lure.

Vivian's field notes

57 An interviewee in the press says there is no foolproof way to screen out scammers

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Accessed 3 November 2026

58 And dommes say community reputation weeds out fakes over time.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

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Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.